SAMPLE

Slavery and Freedom: The Owned and the Owner in the Book

The Slave-File, the Freedom-Economy, and the Manumission-Path -- From Property to Person

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Free sample: Introduction & Chapter 1
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Introduction

This book is an educational study of Slavery and Freedom as presented in the Quran. The primary source is the Quran; where Hadith, classical fiqh, or history (including the manumission-case-law and the later empires' deviations) is referenced, it is drawn from established sources and clearly indicated. English translations of Quranic verses are interpretive and should be cross-referenced with the original Arabic text.

This work is a study and reflection, not a fatwa and not a substitute for formal Islamic education. Readers are encouraged to consult qualified scholars for religious rulings.

Chapter 1: The Freedom-Frame -- The Two-Men Parable

The Book's own foundation-argument for the tawhid is drawn from the slavery-experience itself: "Allah strikes a parable: a man, a slave owned by others, unable to do anything of his own -- and a man whom We provided from Ourselves a good provision, and he spends of it openly and secretly. Are they equal? Praise to Allah -- but most of them do not know" (16:75) -- the two-men file, and the scholars' standing note at the parable's own logic (labeled): the first man is the idolater (owned by many masters who can neither feed nor free him), the second the believer (provided by the One and generous from the provision) -- the Book arguing the tawhid at the institution's own grammar: ownership by the many versus provision by the One, the slave's own powerlessness the parable's own first premise, and the whole file of this book judged at the parable's standing-scale: the human being is owned either way (the creature-ontology), and the only question the parable asks is by whom.

The sequel-parable doubles the argument at the honesty-register: "And Allah strikes a parable of two men: one of them mute, unable to do anything, a burden on his master -- wherever he sends him he brings no good. Is he equal to one who commands justice and is on a straight path?" (16:76) -- the mute-burden against the just-commander: the false lord (the mute idol) and the true Lord (the commanding Guide), and the scholars' synthesis at the pair (labeled): the two parables file the whole tawhid-case at the social-register -- the owned-by-many brings nothing, the provided-by-One commands justice -- and the slavery-file of the chapters that follow reads inside this frame: the Book's own goal for every human being is the second man's own condition (provided, straight, generous), and no institution that keeps a person in the first man's powerlessness is ever called the Book's own destination.

The frame's own crest stands at the rizq-register the whole series builds on (2:107: "Do you not know that to Allah belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth?"; 10:66's own ownership-clause), and the scholars' standing synthesis at the whole ownership-theology (labeled): the Book owns the ownership -- every deed, every dirham, every owned person stands inside the one Owner's own estate (the amanah-frame of 4:58, the trust the series' Banking volume reads at the wealth-economy), and the human master is himself owned (the parable's own first premise turned on the owner: the one who owns a slave is himself the slave of the One) -- the whole file's standing-calibration, and every later chapter's rulings read at the frame's own first floor: the institution judged by the tawhid, the owned person honored by the honor-clause (17:70, Chapter 8), and the exit-doors commanded at the estate's own expense (9:60's zakat-line, Chapter 3).

The freedom-frame's own third-file stands at the ownership-clause's widest register: "Indeed those whom you call upon besides Allah are slaves like you" (7:194 -- the idols themselves called owned: the whole pantheon demoted to the creature-file), and 10:66's own estate-clause: "and Allah is not unmindful of what you do" (the false-gods file read at the same slave-grammar: every rival-lord legislated a fellow-slave before the Court) -- the scholars' standing synthesis at the whole register (labeled): the Book's tawhid-argument runs the species-and-the-pantheon through one word -- abd, slave -- the human being and the idol both owned, the only distinction the Owner's own existence, and the whole slavery-file of this book read at the register's own standing-scale: the social institution judged by the theology that levels the owner himself (16:75's first premise turned on every master), and the reader's own standing-position filed at the verse's own honest grammar: there are no free beings in the Book's own universe -- there are only well-owned and badly-owned ones, and the whole book of freedom is the Book's own manual for the difference.